



THE
**PERFORMANCE
LENS**

SIMULATE · ASSESS · DEVELOP

HUMAN SKILLS FOR A DIGITAL FUTURE

Resource Pack

Your take-home companion after the workshop — the three frameworks from your workshop, a worked example of each, and space to turn what you noticed into a real change you make.

THIS PACK INCLUDES

01	02	03	04	05	06
How to use this pack	The three frameworks	Quick reference	The frameworks in depth	Reflection worksheets	Glossary

START HERE

You've already done the hard part

You've just spent a day with your team — communicating, making decisions, and working together under real pressure. You saw what your team does well and where it struggles under pressure. This pack is for what comes next.

This is a toolkit to keep: the three frameworks from your workshop, a worked example of each, and the exact words you can use when the moment comes.

— THINK OF THESE AS YOUR SUPPORT SYSTEM

In the room, the frameworks felt deliberate — maybe even slow. That's the point. Lean on them on purpose: reach for the page the next time you hit a communication breakdown, a hard decision, or friction on the team. With repetition they stop being something you look up, and start being something you just do.

— HOW TO USE THIS PACK

When a task gets handed off and people aren't sure what was agreed — [run The Clarity Loop](#).

When the team can't commit to a decision, or keeps reopening one — [run The Decision Engine](#).

When people are working hard but not together, or a meeting starts to heat up — [run The Collaboration Reset](#).

Keep this nearby. You don't need to read it cover to cover — pull it out when a pattern shows up and go straight to the framework that matches.

THE THREE FRAMEWORKS

Three tools from your workshop

Each framework is a simple, repeatable habit you can build. Here they are to keep, with a worked example of each. Start with whichever matches the pattern you see most on your team; the others are here when you're ready.

COMMUNICATION

01

The Clarity Loop

Reach for it before any handoff, task assignment, or next step is confirmed.

DECISION-MAKING

02

The Decision Engine

Reach for it before any decision that involves more than one person.

COLLABORATION

03

The Collaboration Reset

Reach for it when the team is stuck and pushing harder isn't working.

Quick Reference

The three frameworks at a glance

FRAMEWORK 01

The Clarity Loop

COMMUNICATION
DIMENSION

High-performing teams don't communicate in straight lines — they close the loop. Most breakdowns come not from bad intentions, but from a loop left incomplete.

THE FIVE STEPS

- State Clearly
- Check Understanding
- Invite Questions
- Adjust Language
- Confirm Alignment

SAY

"So to confirm — you want [what], by [when], in [what format]. Have I got that right?"

KEY SIGNAL

— Tasks come back completed — but to the wrong interpretation.

DIAGNOSTIC PROMPTS

- At your last significant handoff — did you confirm your understanding was correct, or assume that it was?
- Where do things fall through the cracks? Which step of the loop breaks there?

FRAMEWORK 02

The Decision Engine

DECISION-MAKING
DIMENSION

Leadership here isn't charisma — it's structured judgment under constraint. The engine makes a good call possible when information is incomplete and resources are limited.

THE FIVE STEPS

- Define Objective
- Establish What's Known
- Clarify Constraints
- Decide & Commit
- Review & Adjust

SAY

"Who owns this call, and by when? Let's name it out loud."

KEY SIGNAL

— Decisions get revisited in the following meeting — or the one after.

DIAGNOSTIC PROMPTS

- Name a decision your team revisited last month. Which step was incomplete?
- Who clarifies constraints before committing? Who commits, then escalates later?

FRAMEWORK 03

The Collaboration Reset

COLLABORATION
DIMENSION

High-performing teams aren't conflict-free — they reset faster. Conflict isn't the problem; unmanaged conflict is. The Reset is a structured interrupt, not a confrontation.

THE FIVE STEPS

- Pause
- Diagnose the Breakdown
- Clarify Roles
- Re-Align Objective
- Recommit

SAY

"Can we pause for a second — I think we're starting to escalate."

KEY SIGNAL

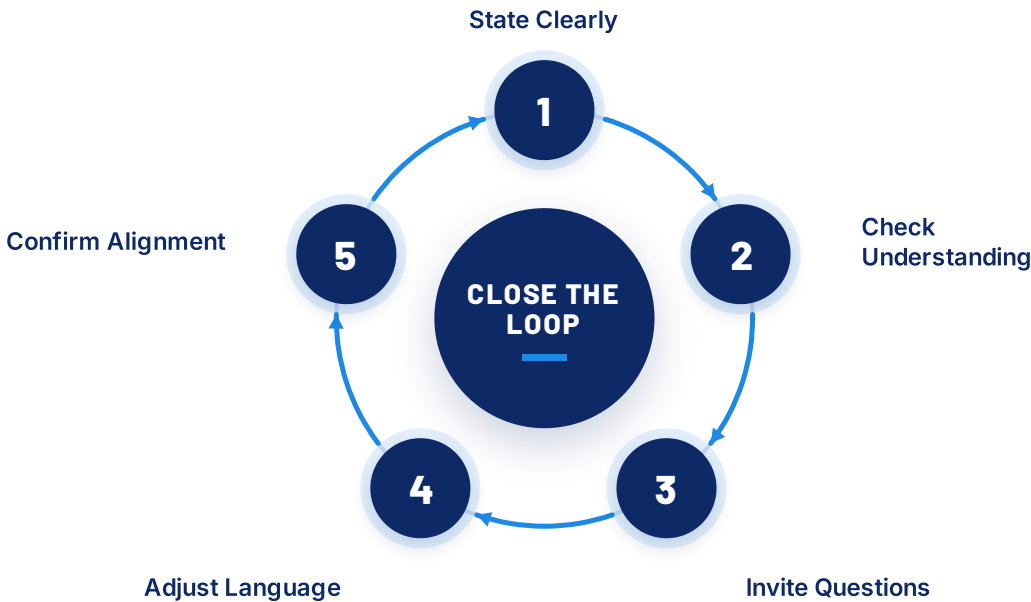
— People are working hard but in parallel — not in coordination.

DIAGNOSTIC PROMPTS

- Where does effort not translate to output? What sits between the two?
- If each person described their role, would the descriptions overlap — or leave gaps?

The Clarity Loop

High-performing teams don't communicate in straight lines — they close the loop. Most breakdowns come not from bad intentions, but from a loop left incomplete.



SEE IT IN ACTION A vague request becomes a clear one

BEFORE

"Can you put together something about our customer complaints for the leadership meeting next week?" Five people would build five different things — a report, a slide deck, a data dump, a quick verbal update.

AFTER

Run the loop and the receiver plays it back: **"So — a 5-slide summary of the top three complaint categories and recommended fixes, for next Tuesday's leadership meeting. Correct?"** Same conversation, zero rework.

WORDS YOU CAN USE

To check understanding

"Just so I'm clear — are you after [X] or [Y]?" · "What does success look like here?"

To invite questions

"What's still unclear?" · "What constraints should we keep in mind?" · "What risks do you see?"

To adjust language

"When you say '[vague phrase]', do you mean [A] or [B]?"

To close the loop

"So to confirm — you want [deliverable], by [when], in [format]. Have I got that right?"

REACH FOR IT WHEN

- Before any handoff, task assignment, or next step is confirmed.
- After a meeting where alignment was assumed rather than verified.
- When the same misunderstanding keeps happening between the same people.

WHAT BREAKS IT

- ✗ Asking "any questions?" instead of asking for a playback.
- ✗ Moving to action when only the sender has confirmed understanding.
- ✗ Treating silence as alignment.



Before we move on — what do we each think we're doing next?

The five steps, explained

1

State Clearly

PURPOSE

Give the other person everything they need to act — the objective, the deliverable, and the context — before any work starts.

WHY IT MATTERS

Most people stop at a vague instruction and assume the rest is obvious. It isn't — and the gap only shows up when the work comes back wrong.

HOW IT WORKS

Be specific about what's needed, by when, in what format, at what quality, and for whom. Don't stop at the task; include the why.

EXAMPLE

Not "Have this ready by Friday," but "Prepare a 5-slide summary on risks, impact, and next steps for Friday's 3pm leadership meeting."

2

Check Understanding

PURPOSE

Confirm the message landed the way you meant it — before anyone acts on it.

WHY IT MATTERS

"I understand" is not understanding. Surfacing the gap early costs a sentence; surfacing it late costs the whole deliverable.

HOW IT WORKS

Ask the receiver to say back what they understood, and what success looks like to them. You're listening for differences, not nods.

EXAMPLE

"Just so we're aligned — what's your understanding of what this needs to cover?"

3

Invite Questions

PURPOSE

Make it safe and expected to raise what's unclear, before work begins.

WHY IT MATTERS

"Any questions?" gets silence. Real questions surface hidden constraints and create shared ownership of the outcome.

HOW IT WORKS

Replace "Any questions?" with specific openers: "What's unclear?", "What constraints should we consider?", "What risks do you see?"

EXAMPLE

"What might get in the way of hitting Friday? What would you need from me?"

4

Adjust Language

PURPOSE

Reshape the message until it actually lands for this person, in this moment.

WHY IT MATTERS

The same words don't land the same way for everyone. Adjusting in the moment prevents a confident-but-wrong start.

HOW IT WORKS

If something isn't clicking, break it down, give an example, or drop the jargon. Clarity is iterative, not one-and-done.

EXAMPLE

"When I said 'a quick overview,' I mean one slide per risk — not a full report."

5

Confirm Alignment

PURPOSE

Close the loop so both sides can state the same objective, constraints, timeline, and definition of done.

WHY IT MATTERS

An open loop is invisible — it feels finished but isn't. Closing it is the difference between rework and confidence.

HOW IT WORKS

Have the receiver summarise the agreement back. If they can't, the loop isn't closed yet.

EXAMPLE

"So to confirm — five slides on the top three risks, with recommended next steps, by Friday 3pm. Have I got that right?"

The Decision Engine

Leadership here isn't charisma — it's structured judgment under constraint. The engine makes a good call possible when information is incomplete and resources are limited.



SEE IT IN ACTION **A launch under pressure**

BEFORE

A product launches in 48 hours and problems are surfacing across teams. People jump straight into debate, defend their own positions, and reach the deadline without a clear decision.

AFTER

The team runs the engine:

- **Define the objective** — protect the launch and the team's credibility.
- **Clarify constraints** — 48 hours, a fixed budget, no moving the date.
- **Allocate resources** — put the team's limited time on the biggest unknowns first.
- **Decide & commit** — “Launch the core feature now. Hold the add-on for version 1.1.” One owner, named out loud.
- **Review & adjust** — set a check-in for day three to confirm it was the right call.

The result: *a clear decision the team can move behind, instead of a stall at the deadline.*

WORDS YOU CAN USE

- To define the objective**

“What outcome are we optimising for here?”
- To clarify constraints**

“What's fixed — time, budget, scope? What can't we move?”
- To allocate resources**

“Where should we spend our limited time and attention first?”
- To decide & commit**

“Who owns this call, and by when? Let's name it out loud.”
- To review**

“When will we come back and check whether this was the right call?”

REACH FOR IT WHEN

- > Before any decision that involves more than one person.
- > When a decision keeps getting re-opened after it was made.
- > When the team is stuck circling the options.

WHAT BREAKS IT

- ✗ Jumping to options before the objective is defined.
- ✗ Leaving accountability unnamed (“we'll figure out who owns this”).
- ✗ Never scheduling the review, so a decision can't be re-opened cleanly.

“ Before we choose — have we named the constraints this decision can't violate?

The five steps, explained

1

Define Objective

PURPOSE

Name the outcome you're actually optimising for, before discussing options.

WHY IT MATTERS

Without a clear objective, a team defaults to activity and pulls in different directions. The objective is what every later step is measured against.

HOW IT WORKS

State the desired result, what success looks like, the time horizon, and how important it is relative to other priorities.

EXAMPLE

"Our objective is to protect the launch date without damaging quality — not to fix every issue."

2

Establish What's Known

PURPOSE

Separate what the team actually knows from what it is assuming, before weighing any option.

WHY IT MATTERS

Most poor calls come from assumptions everyone believed were facts, not from bad reasoning. Splitting the two shows you what you are actually deciding on.

HOW IT WORKS

Put the confirmed facts on one side and the assumptions on the other, and say out loud which is which. Anything nobody has checked is named as an assumption, not treated as ground truth.

EXAMPLE

"We know the vendor confirmed Friday. We are assuming the client has signed off, and nobody has checked."

3

Clarify Constraints

PURPOSE

Surface the real limits the decision has to live within, before committing rather than after.

WHY IT MATTERS

Ignored constraints create plans that cannot survive contact with reality. Named constraints turn guesswork into intelligent trade-offs.

HOW IT WORKS

Name what is fixed: time, budget, authority, information, people. Make them explicit so trade-offs are deliberate.

EXAMPLE

"We have 48 hours and a fixed budget, and the date cannot move. That is what we are working inside."

4

Decide & Commit

PURPOSE

End the exploring, make the call, and get the team genuinely behind it.

WHY IT MATTERS

Half-decisions create confusion and quiet second-guessing. A clear, owned decision creates direction the team can move behind.

HOW IT WORKS

Choose, name who owns it, and record it. Everyone aligns — including those who disagreed — so it doesn't get re-litigated later.

EXAMPLE

"Decision: launch the core feature now, hold the add-on for v1.1. Maria owns it. We're committed."

5

Review & Adjust

PURPOSE

Come back to the decision with real data and adjust based on what actually happened.

WHY IT MATTERS

A decision with no review can't be reopened cleanly — so people either cling to it or quietly abandon it. The review keeps it honest.

HOW IT WORKS

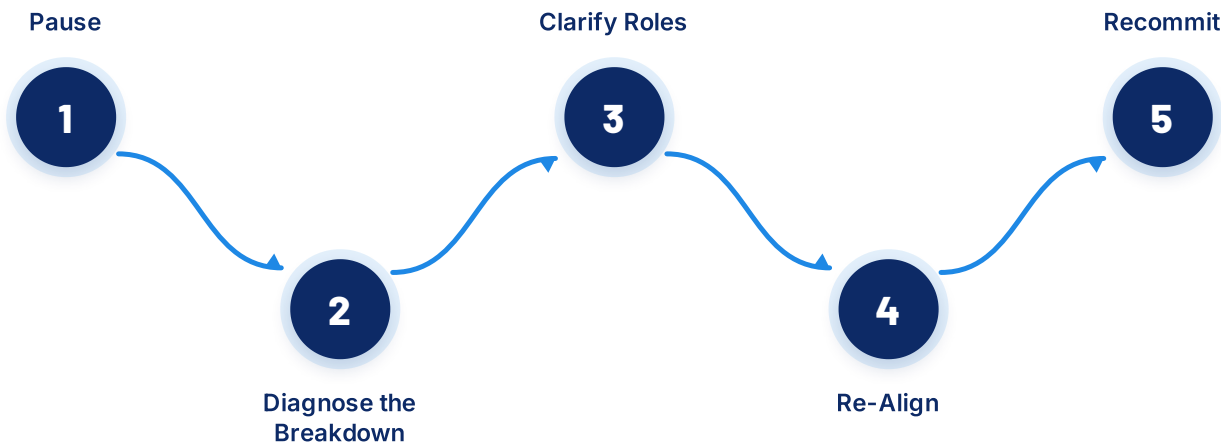
Schedule the check-in up front. Ask: did this move us toward the objective? What's changed? What needs recalibrating?

EXAMPLE

"Day-three check-in: the core feature is stable, so we'll green-light the add-on for next sprint."

The Collaboration Reset

High-performing teams aren't conflict-free — they reset faster. Conflict isn't the problem; unmanaged conflict is. The Reset is a structured interrupt, not a confrontation.



SEE IT IN ACTION An escalating cross-team meeting

BEFORE

A week before a major event, the venue, marketing, schedule and vendors are all slipping. Four departments arrive and start defending turf and assigning blame. Three minutes in, nothing has moved.

AFTER

Someone calls a reset: **pause the blame**, diagnose the breakdown (marketing was waiting on partnerships), clarify roles (ops owns the venue, finance owns vendor approvals), re-anchor to the goal (an investor-ready event), and recommit — ops confirms layout by Tuesday, finance approves vendors by Wednesday, check-in Thursday.

WORDS YOU CAN USE

- To pause**
"Can we pause for a second — I think we're starting to escalate."
- To diagnose the breakdown**
"What are we each assuming is true right now? What might we be missing?"
- To clarify roles**
"Who owns this decision? Who's responsible for what?"
- To re-align**
"What are we trying to achieve in this moment?"
- To recommit**
"So the next step is [X], owned by [Y], by [when] — we'll check in on [date]."

REACH FOR IT WHEN

- > When the team is stuck and pushing harder isn't working.
- > When the same breakdown keeps happening between the same people.
- > When role boundaries are unclear and things are slipping.

WHAT BREAKS IT

- ✗ Pushing harder when the problem is structural, not motivational.
- ✗ Assuming people know their role after the plan has changed.
- ✗ Treating breakdown as failure rather than a signal to reset.

“ Before we push harder — is everyone clear on what they own right now?

The five steps, explained

1

Pause

PURPOSE

Interrupt a conversation that's escalating, before it does damage.

WHY IT MATTERS

When people are interrupting, repeating themselves, or getting defensive, pushing harder adds heat, not progress. The pause breaks the spiral.

HOW IT WORKS

Call a deliberate stop — not to avoid the issue, but to slow the system down so people can think clearly again.

EXAMPLE

"Can we pause for a second? I think we're talking past each other."

2

Diagnose the Breakdown

PURPOSE

Work out what broke in the system, rather than who is at fault.

WHY IT MATTERS

Under pressure teams reach for blame, which protects egos and repairs nothing. Naming the break in the system gives everyone something they can actually fix.

HOW IT WORKS

Trace back to the point where the work stopped lining up: a missing handoff, an owner nobody named, an assumption nobody tested. Name the mechanism, not the person.

EXAMPLE

"Nothing moved between Tuesday and Thursday because neither of us knew the schedule needed sign-off first."

3

Clarify Roles

PURPOSE

Re-establish who owns what, so effort stops colliding.

WHY IT MATTERS

Chaos grows when ownership is unclear — two people do the same thing, or no one does it. Clear roles dissolve the overlap.

HOW IT WORKS

Name who's leading the discussion, who owns the decision, who executes, and who only needs to give input.

EXAMPLE

"Ops owns the venue, Finance owns vendor approvals. Everyone else gives input, not direction."

4

Re-Align Objective

PURPOSE

Re-anchor everyone to the shared goal, away from defending their corner.

WHY IT MATTERS

Under tension, people fight for their position instead of the outcome. Re-aligning shifts the room from personal to collective.

HOW IT WORKS

Ask what you're actually trying to achieve right now, which problem to solve first, and what success looks like in this moment.

EXAMPLE

"Right now, the goal is an investor-ready event. Let's solve the schedule first."

5

Recommit

PURPOSE

Turn the reset into motion with a clear, owned next step.

WHY IT MATTERS

Without this, the team feels calmer but nothing actually moves. The recommit converts a good conversation into progress.

HOW IT WORKS

Agree the immediate action, who owns it, when it happens, and when you'll check in again.

EXAMPLE

"Next step: Ops confirms the layout by Tuesday. We check in Thursday at 10."

The Clarity Loop

These prompts are for you — nobody else needs to see them, and there are no right answers. Pick the dimension you most want to develop and start there.

1

Think of a recent miscommunication that caused a problem. What did people assume? What was never checked?

2

Who around you naturally drives clarity — asks the follow-up, confirms understanding?

3

When did unclear instructions lead to redone work? Would a quick playback have prevented it?

4

Pick one handoff this week. How will you use the Clarity Loop, and what will you say?

The Decision Engine

These prompts are for you — nobody else needs to see them, and there are no right answers. Pick the dimension you most want to develop and start there.

1

Think of a decision your team reopened after making it. Which step was missed — objective, constraints, resources, commit, or review?

2

On your team, do you usually name constraints before a decision, or find them out afterward?

3

When decisions stall around you, is it from too few options or no clear commitment? What would help?

4

Take a real decision coming up. What's the objective? The constraints? Who decides, and when will you review it?

The Collaboration Reset

These prompts are for you — nobody else needs to see them, and there are no right answers. Pick the dimension you most want to develop and start there.

1

Think of a time teamwork broke down under pressure. Who pushed harder, and who tried to reset?

2

Where do two people end up owning the same thing without agreeing on it? What does that cost the team?

3

When things get tense on your team, what's the first sign? Do you have an agreed way to call a pause?

4

Pick one breakdown that keeps happening. How could you interrupt it with a reset, and what would you say to pause it?

REFERENCE

Glossary

Snapshot

How you showed up in specific exercises on one day under pressure — a moment, not a label or a measure of ability.

Defaults

The patterns you fall back on automatically under pressure — habits rather than choices. Pressure makes them visible.

The Decision Engine

The decision-making framework. Define the objective, clarify constraints, allocate resources, decide and commit, then review.

Verified Alignment

Agreement that has been actively confirmed by everyone — not assumed because no one objected.

Constraints

The real limits a decision has to work within: time, budget, scope, authority, or information. Naming them up front turns guesswork into clear trade-offs.

Assumptions

Things we treat as true without checking. Surfacing them is part of Check Understanding in the Clarity Loop and Diagnose the Breakdown in the Collaboration Reset, because hidden assumptions are where misalignment starts.

Playback

Repeating what you understood in your own words — not "I understand," but "What I'm hearing is..." The verification step most teams skip.

Handoff

Any point where work or responsibility passes from one person to another. The most common place clarity gets lost.

Dimension

One of the three things the workshop measures: Communication, Decision-Making, and Collaboration.

Behavioural Archetype

A description of how a team or person tended to operate under the workshop's conditions. Describes current patterns, not fixed traits.

The Clarity Loop

The communication framework. Clarity must be verified, not assumed — the receiver closes the loop before work begins.

The Collaboration Reset

The collaboration framework. When things break down, reset the system rather than push harder: pause, diagnose the breakdown, clarify roles, re-align, recommit.

Role Collision

When two or more people overlap on the same responsibility without agreeing it — a common, quiet source of friction under pressure.

Objective

The specific outcome you're trying to achieve. Naming it first — the opening move of the Decision Engine — stops a team defaulting to activity without direction.

Closing the loop

Confirming understanding before work begins, so both sides can state the same objective, timeline, and definition of success. The core move of the Clarity Loop.

Escalation

When a conversation shifts from solving the problem to defending positions — voices rise, people interrupt. The signal to call a Collaboration Reset.

Pressure reveals defaults

The principle behind the workshop: under time and constraint, people stop performing and start defaulting. That's what the exercises were built to surface.

See it. **Reset.** Move forward together.

Human skills for a digital future.

